

Talia Honikman

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SUMMARY

Linguist and software engineer with a formal pragmatics background who writes publicly about how language models behave. Two years owning and shipping product at Ford. Seeking roles where research, communication, and product thinking intersect.

EXPERIENCE

Ford Motor Company — Palo Alto, CA

Software Engineer & Product Owner, May 2024 – Present

- Owned and shipped two Swift/iOS applications end-to-end as developer and product owner, scaling deployment from 1 to 11 manufacturing plants in five months
- Led specification reviews to translate operational workflows into requirements, edge cases, specs
- Designed and deployed NLP classification pipelines for report routing; documented integration constraints for engineering and QA teams
- Extended a YOLO-based object-detection system from iOS to macOS for assembly workflows; testing validated a measurable reduction in manual QA steps
- Designed and led an internal NLP education series on classification and intent detection, accelerating adoption of the text-classification pipeline across engineering and QA

Emergent Microgrid — Santa Barbara, CA

Product & Content Intern, Mar 2020 – Oct 2020

- Translated technical hardware and integration specs into product narratives; authored PRDs aligning product and marketing; analyzed usage data for customer case studies

SELECTED PROJECTS & WRITING

- **Gricean Maxim Classifier** — Python, RoBERTa, Hugging Face. Transformer model to classify pragmatic maxim violations; hand-annotated corpus with adversarial flouting-vs-violating distinction
- **The Hedge** (Substack) — Essays on language-model behavior, formal pragmatics, and food science, including empirical write-ups of how models handle pragmatic inference

EDUCATION

San Jose State University — San Jose, CA

Post-Baccalaureate Coursework, Computational Linguistics, 2026 – Present

- Corpus Linguistics · Topics in NLP · English as a Global Language

Boston University — Boston, MA

BA in Linguistics, 2024

- Capstone: The Effect of Intensifiers on the Perceived Polarity of Utterances
- Relevant coursework: Experimental Pragmatics, Computational Linguistics, Data Structures, Formal Pragmatics and Semantic Analysis

ACTIVITIES & SERVICE

- **Tuberculosis Advocacy Volunteer, TBFighters** (2023–Present) — Organized advocacy event in Washington DC as part of a team; met with congressional offices at TB Hill Day (2025, 2026) to advocate for restored federal TB funding; profiled in the Stanford Journal of Public Health (2026)
- **Section Violinist, Boston Civic Symphony** (2021–2024)

SKILLS, LANGUAGES & INTERESTS

Technical: Python, Swift, TypeScript/React, SQL, Core ML, RESTful APIs, Git, Xcode, Markdown, Figma, LaTeX

NLP / ML: RoBERTa, Hugging Face, text classification

Languages: English (native) · French (B2) · Italian (B1)

Interests: Classical violin, recipe development, distance running, third-tier English football, film photography